

Dhyey Patel — Portfolio Redesign

Dark & Cinematic • Deep Charcoal + Amber Gold • Bold Motion

1. Design Direction

A premium, cinematic engineering portfolio inspired by high-end SaaS and studio sites (Linear, Vercel, Awwwards). The mood is confident, quiet-luxury: deep charcoal canvas with warm amber accents, generous whitespace, editorial typography, and purposeful motion. Every interaction whispers craft.

2. Color Palette

Token	Hex	Usage
Ink (bg)	#0B0F14	Primary background — cinematic charcoal
Panel	#0F172A	Elevated sections, cards
Surface	#111827	Subtle card fills
Amber (accent)	#F5B84A	CTAs, highlights, glows
Amber Deep	#C9922F	Hover/active accent
Bone	#EDE7D9	Primary text on dark
Muted	#94A3B8	Secondary text
Line	#1E293B	Borders & dividers

3. Typography

- **Display / Headlines:** Fraunces (variable serif) — editorial weight, italic optical size for hero words.
- **UI / Body:** Inter — clean geometric sans, tight kerning.
- **Mono:** JetBrains Mono — terminal, code, engineering labels.
- Hero uses a mix: serif italic word (e.g. *engineering*) juxtaposed with clean sans for a signature, cinematic look.

4. Layout & Sections

Home / Hero

Full-viewport charcoal stage. Ambient amber grain + subtle particle field. Left: oversized headline 'Engineering Digital Experiences' with serif italic accent. Terminal-style status pill. Right: floating stat cards (6+ products, 15+ tech, 3 AI systems). Magnetic CTA buttons.

About

Two-column: portrait card with amber ring + short bio. Location, education chips. Scroll-reveal fade + slide.

Expertise

Grid of tech categories (Languages, Backend, Data, AI/ML). Marquee ribbon of tools (GIT · LINUX · AWS · FASTAPI ...) moving infinitely across the section.

Projects

Cinematic project cards with real imagery (Signly, EduFusionERP, JalDarshi AI, Finora, Procura, Trackademic). Hover: image parallax + amber corner accent + 'View' magnetic pill.

Contact

Split layout: left CTA copy + email, right form (Name, Email, Subject, Message). Submits to backend, stores in MongoDB, toast confirmation.

5. Motion & Interactions (Bold)

- **Custom cursor** — small amber dot + trailing ring, expands on interactive elements.
- **Magnetic buttons** — CTAs subtly follow cursor within 40px radius.
- **Text reveal** — hero words split by character/word, staggered rise on load.
- **Scroll parallax** — background layers move at different rates; project images pan on scroll.
- **Marquee ribbon** — infinite tech-stack strip in Expertise.
- **Section reveals** — IntersectionObserver-driven fade + Y-translate for headings and cards.
- **Amber glow** — hover states cast a soft warm glow on cards and buttons.
- **Terminal blink** — hero status pill with animated caret and typing effect.
- **Grain overlay** — 3% opacity noise texture over hero for cinematic film feel.

6. Component Inventory

- Navbar — sticky, blur backdrop, active-section highlight, resume CTA.
- Hero — headline, sub, stats, dual CTAs, terminal chip, grain, particle canvas.
- About — portrait card, bio, meta chips (Location, Education).
- Expertise — 4 category tiles + marquee strip.
- Project card — image, category tag, title, description, tech chips, feature list, links.
- Contact form — shadcn Inputs/Textarea, submit posts to /api/contact.
- Footer — minimal, social links, copyright, back-to-top.

7. Frontend Stack

- React 19 + React Router + Tailwind + shadcn/ui.
- lucide-react for iconography (no emoji-as-icons).
- Custom hooks: useMagnetic, useReveal, useCursor.

8. Backend Contract (Contact Form)

POST /api/contact

Request:

```
{ "name": string, "email": string, "subject": string, "message": string }
```

Response:

```
{ "id": uuid, "status": "received", "created_at": iso8601 }
```

Storage: MongoDB collection **contact_messages** — { id, name, email, subject, message, created_at }.

GET /api/contact (optional, for future admin view) — returns list of messages.

9. Accessibility & Performance

- AA contrast on all text (bone on ink = 14:1).
- prefers-reduced-motion respected — disables parallax & cursor.
- Lazy-loaded project images, CSS transforms only for animations.
- Keyboard focus rings in amber.

10. Deliverable Checklist

- Redesigned Home / Hero with cinematic motion
- About, Expertise (with marquee), Projects (6 real cards), Contact
- Custom cursor + magnetic buttons + scroll reveals
- Working contact form persisting to MongoDB
- Mobile responsive (breakpoints: 640 / 768 / 1024 / 1280)
- This PDF available at </dhyey-portfolio-design.pdf>